FREE GUIDE · UPDATED NOVEMBER 2026

Catch the Leak:
Track Who Sells Your Email

Give **every company its own email address**, send them all to your Gmail, and find out who shares your email behind your back.

- ✔ Plain English, step by step
- ✔ Main walkthrough uses **Cloudflare** (the email forwarding is free)
- ✔ Plus: other domain hosts, and a no-domain Gmail trick



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A NOTE FROM ME

My idea, years in the making



Hi, I'm Anthony W. Ford, Jr. (Tony Ford).

This guide is my own original idea. I've been using this trick for years: giving every company its own email address so I can see who sells or shares my information after promising they don't. Most of them do.

For a long time I did it with other domain hosts. Today I use **Cloudflare** for all of my domains, because its email forwarding is free and simple, so that's what this guide walks you through.

How this guide was made

This beautiful guide was made by **Grok AI Pro** from my prompts, and I want to give her full credit for it. The idea and the years of doing it are mine. Grok turned them into the simplest steps and pictures, so everyone can understand and follow it.

MY PROMISE

This guide is free. Share it, use it, and protect yourself. Just don't change it, claim it, or sell it.

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START HERE

Welcome! Here's the idea in one minute

Most of us use the same email address everywhere. When spam shows up, we have no idea *who* let our address out. This guide fixes that with one simple trick.

The trick

Instead of giving everyone `you@gmail.com`, you give each company a different address on a domain you own:

NewEgg@yourdomain.com · **Netflix**@yourdomain.com · **MyBank**@yourdomain.com

A **catch-all** setting makes *every* name at your domain land in your normal Gmail. You never have to create the addresses first: just make one up when you sign up.

Why this catches leaks

If email for **NewEgg@yourdomain.com** arrives from anyone *other than* NewEgg, that address travelled somewhere you did not send it. You now have evidence of who shared it.

⚠ READ THIS FIRST: ONLY DO THIS IF YOU'LL KEEP YOUR DOMAIN

Every address you hand out only works while you own the domain. If you forget to renew it, or decide you don't want it anymore, someone else can buy it. From then on, every email sent to your addresses goes to the new owner: password resets, receipts, account alerts, all of it. That can let a stranger take over your accounts. If you ever plan to let a domain go, first log in to every site and service you used it with and change the email to one you'll keep. Otherwise you could lose accounts, or be stuck contacting each company to prove who you are and clean up the mess. So be careful. Only do this if you'll keep the domain paid, keep a list of every account you set up on it, and turn on auto-renew.

What you need

- ☐ **A domain name you own** (for example `yourdomain.com`). Domains cost a yearly fee that depends on the name and where you buy it. The Cloudflare email forwarding in this guide is free.
- ☐ **A free Cloudflare account** (cloudflare.com).
- ☐ **A Gmail address** (or another mailbox you already use) to receive the mail.
- ☐ **About 30 minutes.** Most of that is waiting for the internet to catch up.

NO DOMAIN? NO PROBLEM.

Part 3 shows a free Gmail-only version (plus-addressing) that needs no domain, plus its limits.

What's inside

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Part 3 · Other hosts, and the no-domain Gmail trick pp. 12–14

Extras · FAQ, one-page checklist, sources pp. 15–17



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PART 1 · CLOUDFLARE SETUP

How the pieces fit together

Think of your domain as an apartment building and each alias as a different mail slot. The catch-all is a chute that drops every slot's mail into *one* mailbox: yours.

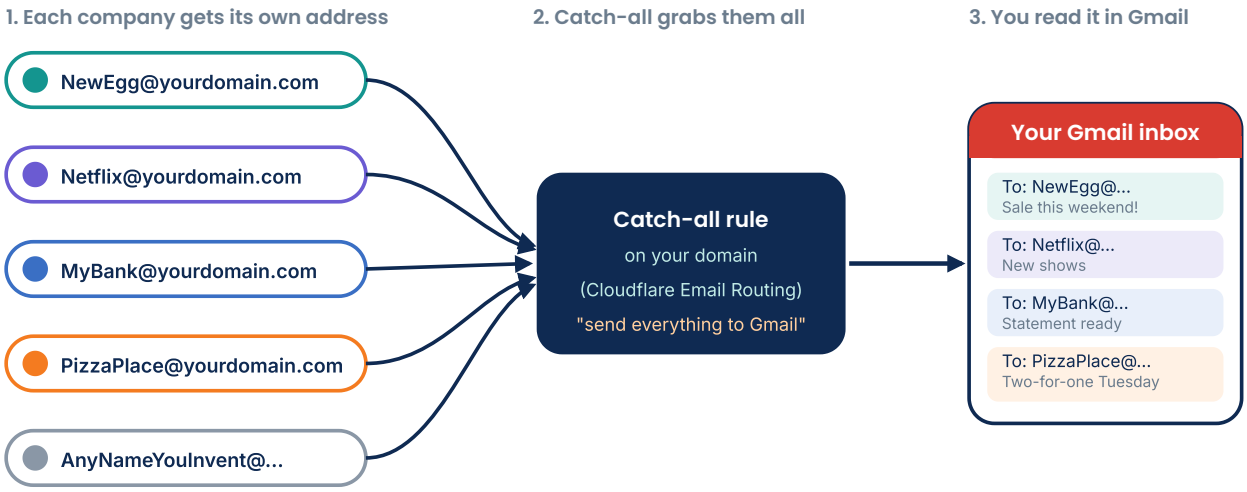


Illustration – the flow from company address to catch-all to your Gmail.



Two good things to know

It forwards, it doesn't store. Cloudflare Email Routing passes mail on to the inbox you choose. Your Gmail is where you read it.

Replies come from your real Gmail. Cloudflare says Email Routing doesn't send or reply as your custom address. If you reply to a forwarded message, the reply is sent from your destination address (like `you@gmail.com`).

BEFORE YOU REPLY TO A COMPANY
Replying shows them your real Gmail address. Use the alias for receiving, and think before you reply.

The 6 steps (about 30 minutes)

#	What you do	Where
1	Put your domain on Cloudflare	Cloudflare + your registrar
2	Turn on Email Routing	Cloudflare
3	Add and verify your Gmail as the destination	Cloudflare + Gmail
4	Switch on the Catch-all rule	Cloudflare
5	Test it	Any other email account
6	Start using a different alias for everything	Everywhere

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PART 1 · CLOUDFLARE SETUP

Steps 1 & 2: Domain on Cloudflare, Email Routing on

Step 1 · Put your domain on Cloudflare

Already see your domain inside your Cloudflare account, or bought it from Cloudflare? Skip to Step 2.

1. Sign in to the Cloudflare dashboard and go to **Domains**, then choose **Onboard a domain**.
2. Type your domain (like `yourdomain.com`), pick how to add your DNS records, and continue. Then pick a plan. Cloudflare says Email Routing is available to all customers who use Cloudflare as their authoritative nameserver.
3. Cloudflare shows the DNS records it found. **Check them.** If your domain already runs a website, make sure its records are there, so the site doesn't break.
4. Cloudflare gives you **two nameservers**. Log in where you bought the domain and replace the nameservers with those two. **Using DNSSEC? Turn it off at your registrar first**, then switch nameservers (Cloudflare says you can turn it back on afterwards from Cloudflare).

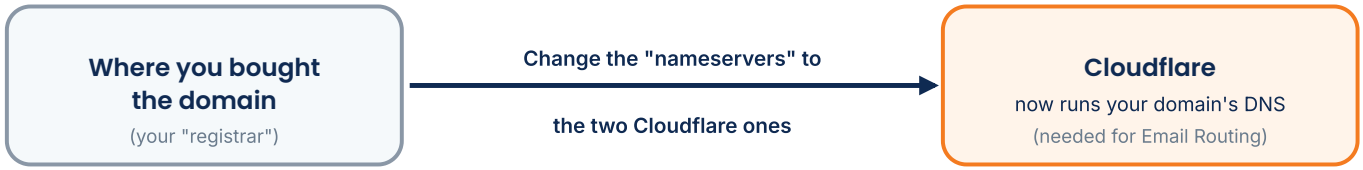


Illustration – you only change the nameservers at your registrar; everything else happens at Cloudflare.

Step 2 · Turn on Email Routing

1. In the Cloudflare dashboard, go to **Compute** > **Email Service** > **Email Routing**.
   Cloudflare's menus get renamed from time to time. If you don't see that path, search the dashboard for "Email Routing".
2. Select **Onboard Domain** and choose your domain from the list.
3. Optional: look over the DNS records Cloudflare is about to add (next page), then select **Done**. Cloudflare adds them for you.

> **BE PATIENT**
> Cloudflare says DNS changes can take up to 24 hours, but usually finish in 5–15 minutes on Cloudflare DNS.

PART 1 · CLOUDFLARE SETUP

What Cloudflare adds for you

You don't type any of these in: Cloudflare adds them to your domain when you click **Done**. They're listed so nothing feels mysterious.

Type	What it looks like	What it's for

MX ×3	`route1.mx.cloudflare.net`
	`route2.mx.cloudflare.net`
	`route3.mx.cloudflare.net`
		Tells the world "deliver this domain's email to Cloudflare."

TXT (SPF)	`v=spf1 include:_spf.mx.cloudflare.net ~all`	Says Cloudflare is allowed to forward mail for your domain.
TXT (DKIM)	name starts with `cf2024-1._domainkey`	A digital signature on forwarded mail.

ALREADY GETTING EMAIL AT THIS DOMAIN SOMEWHERE ELSE?
Email Routing needs Cloudflare's MX records. If your domain has MX records from another provider, Cloudflare stops with error 2008 ("Non-Cloudflare MX records exist"). Switching means mail to that domain will go to Cloudflare, not the old provider, **and addresses with no rule get rejected**. Safest plan: use a separate, new domain just for this.

GOOD TO KNOW
Cloudflare locks these records so you don't break mail by accident (Locked and Unlocked both mean the record is correct). If your domain already has an SPF record, Cloudflare says to merge its `include:_spf.mx.cloudflare.net` into it by hand, keeping just one SPF record.

Step 3 · Add and verify your Gmail

1. Go to **Compute** > **Email Service** > **Email Routing** > **Destination Addresses**.
2. Under **Destination addresses**, type your Gmail address in the form and submit it.
3. Open Gmail. Cloudflare sent you a message. Click **Verify email address**. *(Can't find it? Check Spam.)*

DON'T SKIP VERIFYING
Until the destination is verified, every routing rule that points to it stays disabled. If you later delete the destination, its rules switch off too.

PART 1 · CLOUDFLARE SETUP

Steps 4–6: Catch-all on, test, go!

Step 4 · Switch on the Catch-all rule

1. In **Email Routing**, pick your domain, then open the **Routing Rules** tab.
2. Turn on **Catch-all rule** so it shows **Active**.
3. In **Action**, choose **Send to an email**, and pick your verified Gmail as the destination.
4. Select **Save**.

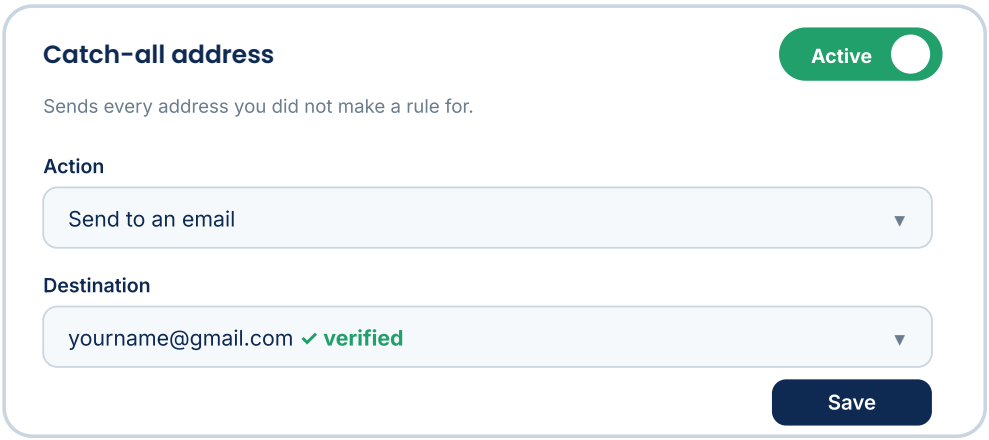


Illustration – the idea of the Catch-all rule. This is NOT a real screenshot; Cloudflare's screen looks different.

What this does: Cloudflare says the catch-all forwards every email sent to your domain, including misspelled local parts, to one destination. That "local part" is the bit before the @. This is how **NewEgg@** works even though you never created it.

Step 5 · Test it

1. From a **different** email account (not the Gmail you're forwarding to), send a message to something you invent, like `test123@yourdomain.com`. *Cloudflare notes that some providers discard messages that appear to come from the same account they're delivered to.*
2. Check your Gmail inbox. If it isn't there in a few minutes, check **Spam**, and wait the 5–15 minutes from Step 2.
3. Still stuck? Open Email Routing's **Activity Log**: it lists received emails and what Email Routing did (for example *Forwarded*, *Dropped*, or *Rejected*).

Step 6 · Use a different alias everywhere

From now on, whenever a site asks for your email, make up an address with the company's name. That's it. No setup per address. Part 2 shows how to name and track them.

> **CHECK IT'S WORKING BEFORE YOU RELY ON IT**
> Don't move your bank or other important accounts to an alias until your test message has arrived.

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PART 2 · CATCH THE LEAK

Name it, write it down

Your detective work is only as good as your naming. One rule: **one alias per company. Never reuse one.**

A simple naming scheme

Company / place	Alias you invent	Why it's good
Newegg (online store)	`newegg@yourdomain.com`	Obvious who it belongs to
Netflix	`netflix@yourdomain.com`	Same pattern every time
Local pizza place	`pizzaplace@yourdomain.com`	Small shops count too
Hobby forum	`forum-woodworking@yourdomain.com`	Hyphen keeps it readable
Same company, second account	`newegg-2@yourdomain.com`	Still unique

DO
Keep names short, lowercase, easy to type. Use the company name exactly as you'd say it.

DON'T
Don't use `info@`, `sales@`, `admin@` or other guessable names: strangers try those. Don't share one alias with two companies.

Keep a simple log

A free spreadsheet (Google Sheets works great) is enough. Add a row every time you sign up somewhere. The **log is your memory**: months later it tells you who was supposed to be the only one with each alias.

Date	Company	Alias	Used for	Mail should only come from	Status
2026-11-02	Newegg	newegg@	Order	newegg.com	✅ OK
2026-11-05	PizzaPlace	pizzaplace@	Coupon	pizzaplace.example	✅ OK
2026-11-09	Super Sweepstakes	sweeps@	Contest	super-sweeps.example	🚩 **Leaked 12/01**

Example log. Make up your own columns; these five are just a good start. (The company names and domains here are made-up examples.)

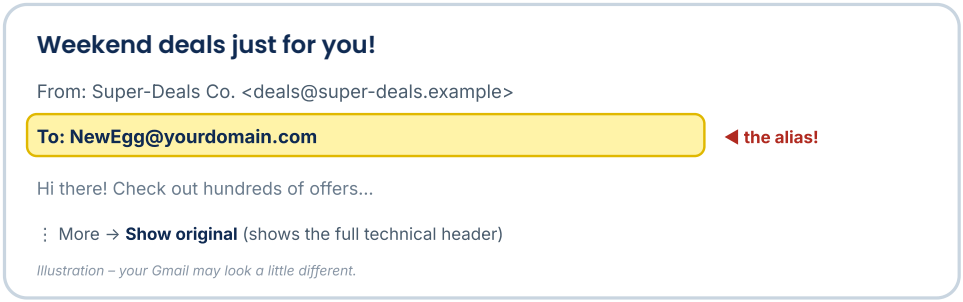
BONUS TIP
Add a column for "what I told them" (for example "didn't tick the marketing box"). It helps later if you contact the company.

PART 2 · CATCH THE LEAK

Read the alias in Gmail

See which alias was used

Open any forwarded message and look at the **To:** line. It usually shows the address the sender wrote, such as `NewEgg@yourdomain.com`.



WHEN THE TO: LINE DOESN'T SHOW YOUR ALIAS

Mass mailings sometimes hide the real recipient (a "BCC"), so **To:** may be blank or generic. Then open **More** (⋮) > **Show original** and use your browser's Find tool to search the header for part of your alias. Header names vary by sender.

Make Gmail sort by alias

Labels and filters do the sorting for you. Gmail's own help describes filters this way: you enter search criteria, create a filter, then choose what it should do (like send to a label, archive, delete, star, or forward).

1. In Gmail's search box, click **Show search options**. In the **To** box type the alias, e.g. `newegg@yourdomain.com`. Click **Create filter**.
2. Tick **Apply the label** and make a label named for the company (e.g. `Aliases/Newegg`). Click **Create filter**.
3. Shortcut: open one message, click **More** > **Filter messages like these**, set the criteria, then **Create filter**.

The leak alarm filter

This one search finds mail sent to an alias by *anyone but* the company. Paste it into Gmail's search box:

```
to:newegg@yourdomain.com -from:newegg.com
```

Anything it finds is a lead. Turn it into a filter that applies a label like `LEAK?` so you notice it.

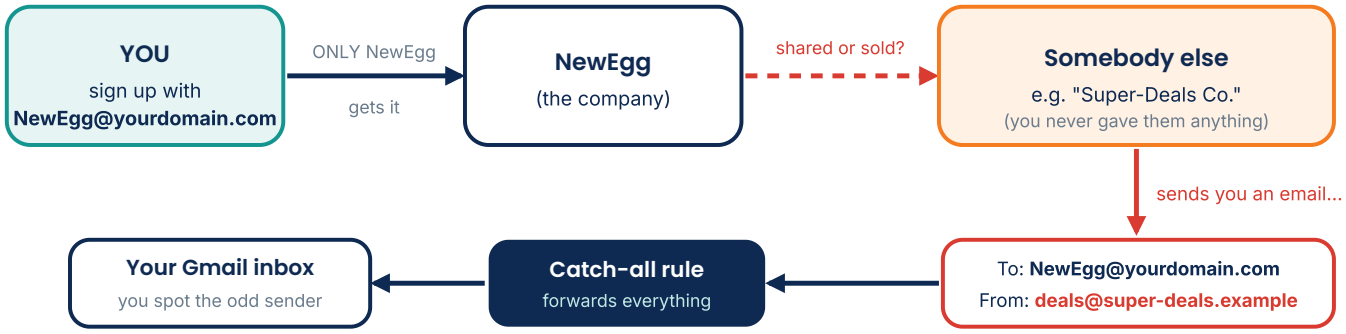
LABEL IT, DON'T AUTO-DELETE IT

Companies often send through several domains (an email-service partner, a billing system, a marketing domain). A different sender is a **clue to check**, not an automatic verdict.

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PART 2 · CATCH THE LEAK

Leak detected! What it means



LEAK SIGNAL

The address **NewEgg@** was given to NewEgg and nobody else. So mail to it from a different sender means your address travelled somewhere you did not send it. That is your clue.

Illustration – the made-up sender "Super-Deals Co." and addresses are examples only.



Be a fair detective

Mail to an alias from a stranger tells you **the address got out**. It doesn't tell you *how*. Possible routes:

- The company sold or shared it with partners (the thing you were hoping to catch).
- A partner or vendor the company legitimately uses, and who sends in its name.
- A data breach at the company or one of its vendors.
- You typed it somewhere else by mistake.

HOW TO BUILD A SOLID CASE

1. **Save the evidence.** Keep the email. In Gmail, **Show original** > **Copy to clipboard** keeps the full header; paste it in a note.
2. **Check your log.** Confirm that alias was only given to that one company, and when.
3. **Check the company's privacy policy.** Does it mention sharing with "partners"? Policies differ.
4. **Look for repeats.** The same stranger hitting several aliases from different companies points to a shared list or breach.

HONEST LIMITS

This method shows **that** an address was passed along, not **who** profited. A catch-all also receives mail sent to names a stranger simply guessed (`info@` , `sales@`), so use unique names (page 8). This is a practical technique, not legal advice.

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PART 2 · CATCH THE LEAK

An alias leaked. Now what?

The best part: you can shut one address off without touching any other.

1. **Keep the proof.** Save the message and its full header (see page 10). Update your log: date, who sent it, which alias.

2. **Unsubscribe or report it.** In Gmail, you can `Report spam`, or open the message and click `More` > `Block "sender"`; after that, future emails from them go to Spam (Gmail Help). If a message asks for personal info, you can report it as phishing too.

3. **Shut the alias.** In Cloudflare, open `Email Routing` > `Routing Rules` > `Create routing rule`. Enter the part before the @ (e.g. `sweeps`), choose your domain, and set Action to `Drop`. Cloudflare says Drop deletes matching mail without routing it. Save. Send a test to make sure it's silent.
   Cloudflare also lets you switch any rule to **Disabled** and back to **Active** if you only want a pause.

4. **Give the company a fresh alias** if you still use them. Log in to your account on their site and change your email to a new alias (like `newegg-2@yourdomain.com`). Update your log.

5. **Ask where it came from.** You can contact the company, quote the alias and date, and ask who they shared it with. You decide how far to take it. Rules about data sharing differ by place, so look up the ones where you live.

DROPPED MAIL IS GONE
Cloudflare's Drop action deletes matching mail. Only drop an alias on an account you've already moved to a new alias, or one you don't need anymore (like a one-time contest). Otherwise you could miss password resets.

TIP: LET GMAIL DO THE QUIET CLEANUP
Instead of dropping at Cloudflare, you can make a Gmail filter for that alias with `Delete it` or `Skip the Inbox`. It's easy to undo later.

Sample note to the company (copy, paste, edit)

Subject: Where did you get my email address?

Hello,
I gave the email address **[alias]@yourdomain.com** only to **[Company]** when I [signed up / bought something] on **[date]**. On **[date]** I received a message at that address from **[sender]**, a company I never contacted.
Please tell me whether you shared my address, who with, and ask them to remove it from their lists.
Thank you,
[Your name]

Use the company's contact form or support address. Sending it from your Gmail would show them your real Gmail address.

PART 3 · EXTRA INFO

Doing this on other domain hosts

Every host calls it something different, but the idea is the same: **"send any address at my domain that has no rule to one mailbox."** Look for the words *catch-all*, *wildcard*, or *default address*.

UNIVERSAL ESCAPE HATCH

If your host doesn't offer a catch-all, you don't have to move your domain. Keep it registered where it is, switch only the **nameservers** to Cloudflare (Step 1), and use Cloudflare Email Routing. Cloudflare's guide links provider-specific nameserver instructions for GoDaddy, Namecheap, Porkbun, and many more.

Host	Catch-all?	Verified notes (from each company's own help pages, November 2026)
Namecheap (free Email Forwarding)	Yes	Needs Namecheap BasicDNS, PremiumDNS or FreeDNS. **Domain List** > **Manage** > **Advanced DNS** > Mail Settings: **Email Forwarding** > Save. Then **Domain** tab > **Redirect Email** > **Add catch all** > enter the destination. A catch-all can go to **one address only**. Allow about an hour. Can't be used alongside Private Email.
Porkbun (free forwarding)	No	Porkbun says wildcard/catch-all forwarding is **not supported**; you create each address by hand (up to 20 free per domain). To get a catch-all, point the domain's nameservers to Cloudflare.
GoDaddy	Varies by product	GoDaddy's catch-all help page has changed, and current steps couldn't be confirmed for any GoDaddy plan. Check GoDaddy's Help Center for your product, or use the Cloudflare nameserver route above.
Google Workspace (paid)	Yes	Admin console: **Apps** > **Google Workspace** > **Gmail** > **Routing** > **Configure / Add Another Rule**. Pick **Inbound messages**, action **Modify message**, tick **Change envelope recipient**, choose **Replace recipient** and enter the catch-all address. Under account types tick **All inactive and unrecognized accounts** only. Changes can take up to 24 hours.
Zoho Mail (hosted mailboxes)	Yes	Admin Console > **Domains** > pick your domain > **Advanced Settings** > **Catch-all Address** > enter an existing user or group mailbox > **Update**. Repeat per domain. You can also add an "Excluded email addresses" list. Check which plan includes it.
Microsoft 365 (Exchange Online)	Possible, not simple	Needs admin tools: a shared mailbox, the domain type set to **InternalRelay**, and a mail-flow rule. A Microsoft Learn wiki page describes it and notes it is **not officially supported**. For a simple catch-all, the Cloudflare route is easier.

HEADS-UP

Hosts change their menus. If a name above has moved, search the host's help for "catch-all" or "wildcard". Always send your test message from a **different** email account.

PART 3 · EXTRA INFO

No domain? Try Gmail "plus" addresses

Gmail has a free built-in version of the trick. Add a plus sign and a word *after* your name and it still lands in your inbox.

`yourname+newegg@gmail.com` → `yourname@gmail.com`

Same inbox, but each company gets a different-looking address.

Gmail Help confirms it: messages sent to `janedoe+school@gmail.com`, `janedoe+notes@gmail.com` and similar all go to `janedoe@gmail.com`, and you can make filters to label, archive, delete, star, or forward them. Everything in Part 2 works the same way (label by the "+" word, watch for mail from anyone else).

Limits (be honest with yourself)

Limit	What it means
Some sites reject the "+"	Many sign-up forms refuse a plus sign in an email address. This is common experience rather than something from Google's docs. If a site refuses it, you can't use that trick there.
Anyone can strip it	The tag is right there in the address. A data seller, spammer, or cleaning tool can delete the "+word" and reach your base address, so the leak may show up at *yourname@gmail.com* and you won't know who sold it.
Your Gmail name is visible	With a domain alias, nobody sees your Gmail name. With "+" aliases, they do.
Dots don't matter	Gmail ignores dots in the name part, so `your.name@` and `yourname@` reach the same inbox. Gmail Help has an article about this. It's a separate feature from "+".

Which should you use?

	Domain catch-all (Parts 1 & 2)	Gmail "+" addresses
Cost	Domain yearly fee; forwarding free on Cloudflare	Free
Leak-proof?	Strong: nothing to strip off	Weaker: the tag can be removed
Sites accept it?	Almost always like a normal address	Some sites refuse "+"
Setup time	About 30 minutes, once	None

BEST OF BOTH

Start with "+" today. When you're ready, move to a domain catch-all for the accounts that matter.

PART 3 · EXTRA INFO

Important: keep your domain alive



Your aliases only work while **you** own the domain.

If you ever let the domain expire, someone else could register it and set up their own catch-all. They could then receive mail sent to *every* alias you gave out, including password-reset emails for accounts tied to those aliases.

THE DANGER, IN PLAIN WORDS

Anyone who controls the domain controls its mail. An expired domain is not "just gone"; it can become someone else's — and they would get password resets, receipts, and account alerts for every address you handed out.

Keep it safe

- ☐ **Turn on auto-renew** (if your registrar offers it) and keep the payment card current.
- ☐ **Add a calendar reminder** a month before the renewal date.
- ☐ **Use a strong password and two-step verification** on your registrar and Cloudflare accounts. Whoever gets into them controls your mail.
- ☐ **Don't build important accounts on a domain you can't afford to renew.** Think of it as a bill that never ends.
- ☐ **Giving up the domain? Move first.** Before you let it lapse, log in to **every** site and service you used it with and change the email to an address you'll keep. If you don't, you could lose accounts, or be stuck contacting each company to prove who you are and clean up the mess.

ONE MORE SAFETY HABIT

Keep a few **important** accounts (bank, health, government) on a normal, stable address, even if you give shops and sites unique aliases. If something goes wrong with a domain, you don't lose the ones you can't replace.

Write it down: Domain: _____ Bought at: _____ Renews on: _____

CLOUDFLARE NOTE

If you ever disable Email Routing for the domain, Cloudflare stops processing incoming email and removes the routing DNS records it added (MX, SPF, DKIM). Don't disable it casually.

EXTRAS

Questions people ask

Is it really free?
Cloudflare's pricing page says inbound Email Routing is unlimited on both the Workers Free and Workers Paid plans. The domain name itself is **not** free: you pay your registrar a yearly fee.

Do I have to create each address first?
No. That's the point of the catch-all: invent a new name any time and it already works. You can still add specific rules for names you care about.

How many addresses can I use?
With the catch-all, any number of names. If you create explicit routing rules, Cloudflare allows up to 200 per domain, and 200 destination addresses per account.

Can I send email *from* my alias?
Not with Email Routing. Cloudflare says replies go out from your destination address (like your Gmail), not the custom address.

Will I get more spam?
A catch-all accepts mail for any name at your domain, so guessed names can reach you. Avoid obvious names (`info@`, `sales@`) and use a Drop rule on any alias that gets noisy.

Does a stranger emailing an alias prove the company sold it?
No. It's strong evidence the address got out, but not *how* (see page 10). Gather proof, check the company's policy, and ask.

What if a website won't accept my domain's address?
Try another alias at the same domain. If a site still refuses, use a Gmail "+" alias or your normal address for that site.

Can the destination be something other than Gmail?
Yes. Cloudflare forwards to a verified destination address, and it can be any mailbox you own. Verification works the same way.

I use my domain for a website. Will this break it?
Email Routing only adds mail records (MX, SPF, DKIM). It doesn't touch your site's records. Still, review your records in Step 1 when you move DNS to Cloudflare.

My domain already has email somewhere else. Can I still do this?
Not on the same domain with Cloudflare Email Routing: other MX records block onboarding. Use a separate domain, or see the other-host options in Part 3.

The test email never arrived.
Wait 5–15 minutes, check Spam, make sure the destination is verified and the Catch-all shows Active, and send the test from a different account. Then look at the Activity Log.

ONE-PAGE CHEAT SHEET

Quick checklist

Setup (do once)

- [ ] Own a domain (e.g. `yourdomain.com`)
- [ ] Free Cloudflare account created
- [ ] Domain added to Cloudflare; nameservers changed at registrar (DNSSEC off first)
- [ ] Email Routing turned on (**Compute > Email Service > Email Routing > Onboard Domain**)
- [ ] MX / SPF / DKIM records added by Cloudflare
- [ ] Gmail added as **Destination address** and **verified**
- [ ] **Routing Rules** > Catch-all **Active** > Send to an email > your Gmail > Save
- [ ] Test email sent from a **different** account and received
- [ ] Auto-renew on for the domain; strong password + 2-step on registrar and Cloudflare

Every sign-up

- [ ] Invent `companyname@yourdomain.com`
- [ ] Write it in your log (date, company, alias)
- [ ] Make a Gmail label/filter for it
- [ ] Don't reply from Gmail unless you must

Every month

- [ ] Run the alarm search: `to:alias@yourdomain.com -from:company.com`
- [ ] Look at the **LEAK?** label
- [ ] Check the Activity Log for odd traffic

If you give up the domain

- [ ] Change the email on **every** account to an address you'll keep, then let the domain go

If an alias leaks

1	Save the email and the full header ("Show original")
2	Report spam / block / unsubscribe in Gmail
3	Cloudflare: new routing rule for that name > Action **Drop** (after moving accounts off it)
4	Switch the account to a fresh alias and update your log
5	Ask the company who they shared it with

REMEMBER
A stranger emailing an alias is **evidence**, not a verdict. Companies can send through partner domains. Check, then decide.

NO DOMAIN?
Use `yourname+company@gmail.com`. It's free, but some sites reject "+", and anyone can strip it off.

EXTRAS

Sources & what's verified

Every step in this guide was checked against the host's own help pages in **November 2026**. Cloudflare's docs have been renamed to "Email Service" and menus move around, so wording on your screen may differ a little.

Topic	Where it was checked
Cloudflare Email Routing: onboarding, DNS records, destination addresses, Catch-all rule, Drop, test steps, 200-rule limits, Activity Log, replies	developers.cloudflare.com/email-routing/ (Route emails; Email routing rules and addresses; Domain configuration; Limits) · developers.cloudflare.com/fundamentals/manage-domains/add-site/
Cloudflare pricing	developers.cloudflare.com/email-service/platform/pricing/
Namecheap	namecheap.com Knowledgebase: "How to set up a catch-all (wildcard) email address" and "How to set up Free Email Forwarding"
Porkbun	kb.porkbun.com: "How to Set Up Email Forwarding Service"
Google Workspace	support.google.com/a/answer/12943537 ("Get misaddressed email in a catch-all mailbox")
Zoho Mail	zoho.com/mail/help/adminconsole/catch-all-setup.html
Microsoft 365	learn.microsoft.com wiki: "Office365: Catch all Mailbox" (notes it is not officially supported)
Gmail: filters, blocking, "+" aliases, Show original	support.google.com/mail: answers 6579, 8151, 22370, 22454

Things not fully verified

- **GoDaddy catch-all steps:** GoDaddy's catch-all help page has changed, so the guide gives no GoDaddy steps.
- **Exact header names** a forwarder adds (so the guide says to search the original header for your alias).
- **Gmail dialog wording** ("Show search options", "Apply the label") is standard Gmail but Google can rename it.
- **"Many sites reject '+'"** is common experience, not from official documentation.
- **The `-from:` search** uses standard Gmail search syntax; test it on your own mail before trusting it.

> **ALL ILLUSTRATIONS ARE ILLUSTRATIONS**
> The diagrams and mock panels in this guide are drawn illustrations, not screenshots of Cloudflare or Gmail. Example domains (yourdomain.com, *.example) are made up.

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